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DIMITRIS PECHLIVANIDIS

Derive

Q3 2026 Benchmark

Work for Alea Research

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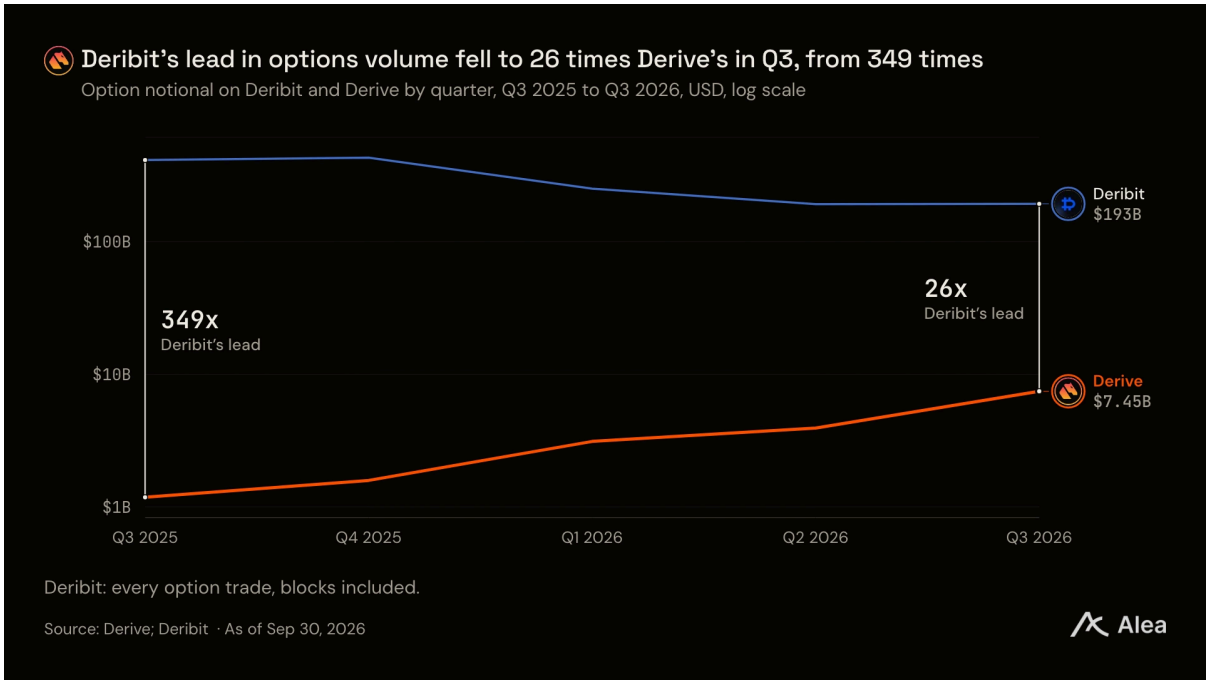
Reports / benchmark

Derive: Q3 2026

October 28, 2026 · 33 min

Derive's options volume grew to 3.9% of Deribit's in Q3, from 0.3% a year earlier, while Derive took nine of every ten dollars of crypto option premium paid onchain. It then moved the whole exchange onto Ethereum with Derive V3, and will be sending more of each fee dollar to DRV buybacks, from 35% through Q3 to half of applicable protocol fees from Oct 14.

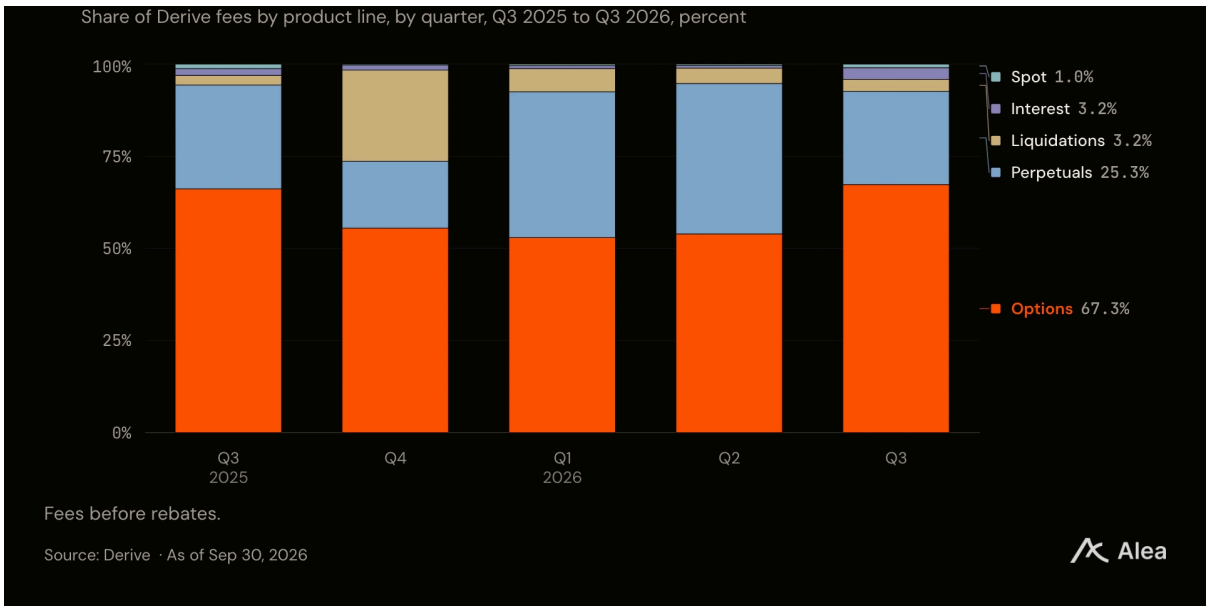
Exhibit 1



Key Takeaways

- **Option notional rose to a record $7.45B, 6.3 times a year earlier, while Deribit's fell 53%.** In ETH, Derive's options volume equaled 10.8% of Deribit's.
- **Holders approved V3 with 99.4% of votes, and on Oct 6 it moved Derive's margin and collateral onto Ethereum.** In Q3 Derive also listed gold options and opened a BitGo custody route for funds.
- **Buybacks now take 50% of applicable protocol fees, about $59K a week at October's pace.** DIP 324 names that share as the base for future staking rewards.
- **DRV rose 243% in Q3, mostly in the week after the V3 proposal.** Its market cap assumes about a 12% share of Deribit's Q3 volume at the peer median, against 3.9% in Q3.
- **Option fees per dollar fell to 1.22 basis points from 1.36, led by the order book.** The order book's rate fell from 2.13 to 1.58 basis points, and RFQ's held near 1.1.

Exhibit 2

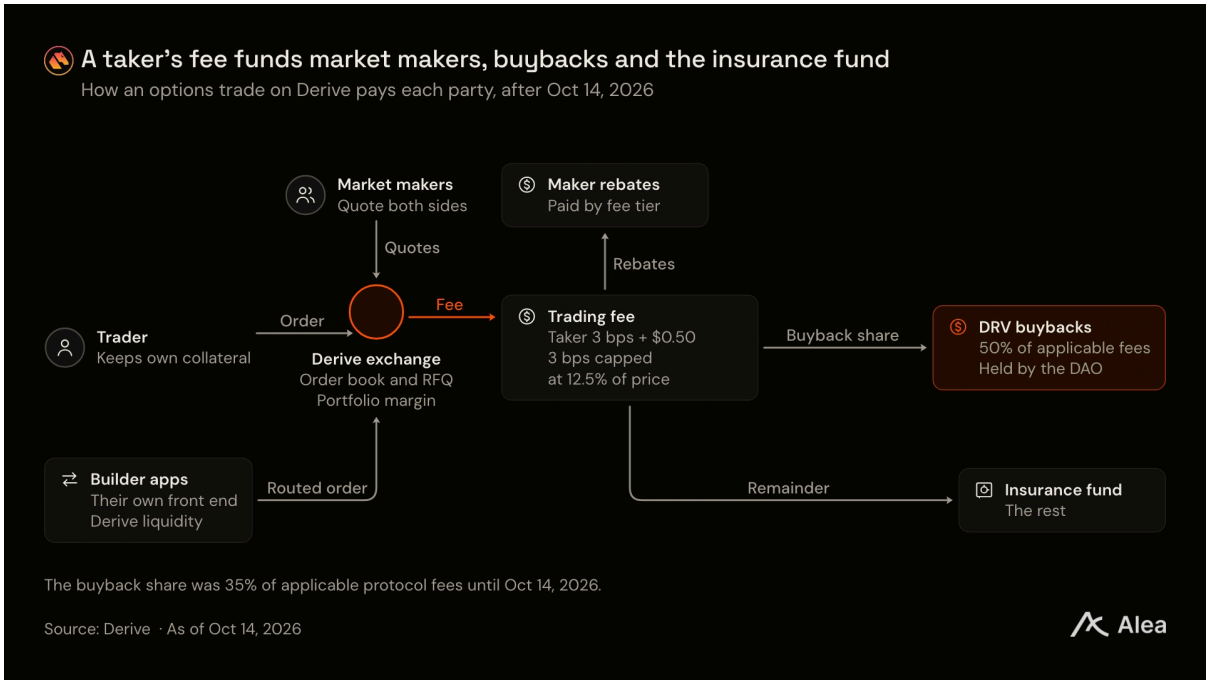


Over five quarters the fee mix swung back toward options, the product Derive was built for, after perpetuals took a larger share of fees in the first half of 2026. Spot, liquidations and interest on USDC loans made up the rest.

How an Options Trade Pays Derive

Derive is an options exchange that runs the same machinery as Deribit: an options order book, request-for-quote (RFQ) blocks, and portfolio margin, with most of its volume in BTC and ETH. The difference is self-custody: collateral sits in Derive's own contracts, on Ethereum since Oct 6, and every trade settles in batches proved there. Front ends such as Heat and Tacticalls route their users' orders into Derive's liquidity and can add their own builder fee. Derive leads in markets Deribit entered late. For example, in Q3 it traded 3.2 times Deribit's HYPE options.

Exhibit 3



The fee is set on notional, with a ceiling tied to the option's price. A taker pays 3 basis points of notional, capped at 12.5% of the option's price, plus $0.50 per order. On a two-leg RFQ spread, the second leg pays nothing. A cheap, far-out-of-the-money option or a two-leg RFQ spread pays less per dollar of notional than a single near-the-money call. Volume and staking tiers cut that rate further. A front end can add its own builder fee on top, which goes to the builder and leaves Derive's fee unchanged. In Q3 takers paid 1.1 basis points per dollar of option notional and 1.7 on perps.

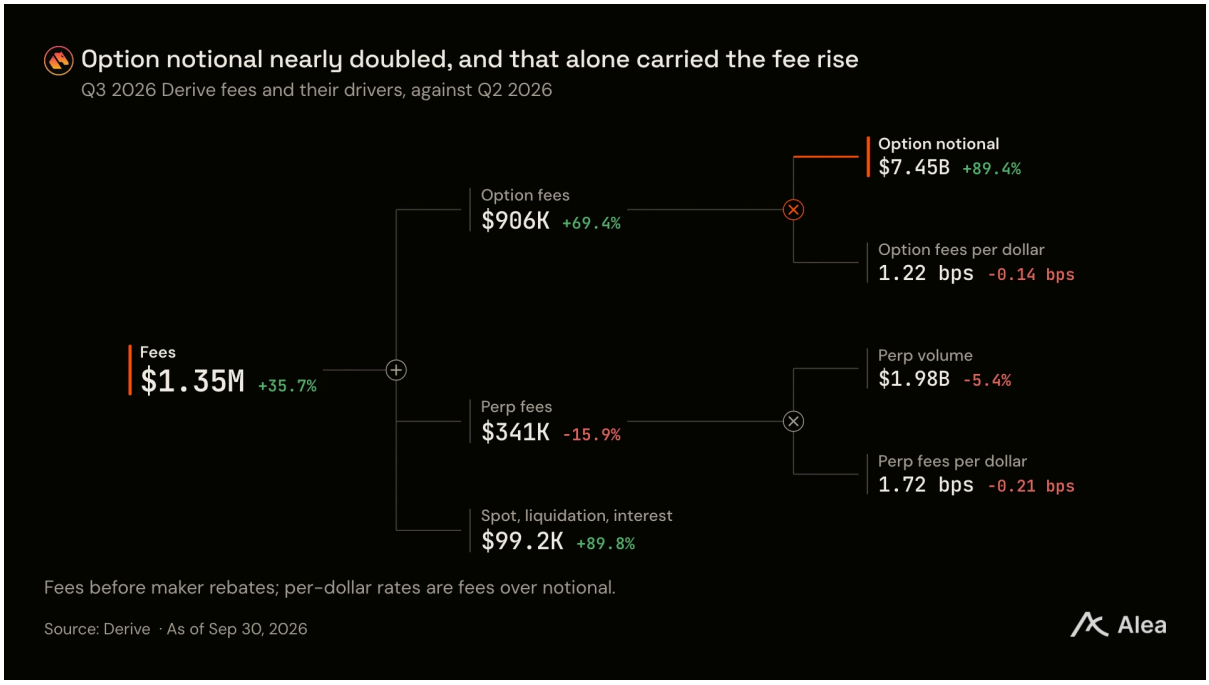
cap, but its order-book makers pay 1 basis point at the base tier. RFQ makers pay the taker rate on the schedule, but after tier discounts they paid 8% of Q3's RFQ fees.

Firms that quote at scale and stake DRV climb a ladder that ends in rebates. Maker rebates come from a USDC pool of up to $500K per 28-day epoch and came to $255K in Q3. Derive also set aside 800,000 DRV per epoch for maker programs through Q3, down from 900,000 in Q2, with new pools for alt and midcap markets.

Option notional carried the fee rise

Fees come from two things: how much notional Derive matches and how much each dollar of it pays. In Q3 options pushed the first up and the second down.

Exhibit 4

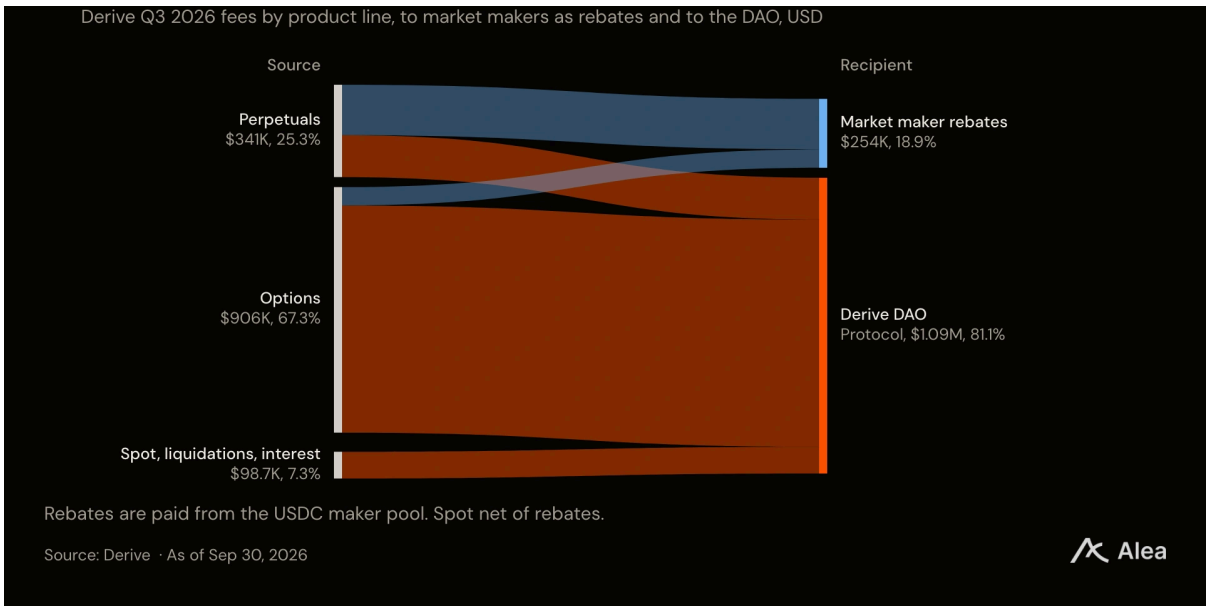


Option notional grew 89% while Deribit's was flat, and option fees rose 69%; the difference is the fee per dollar, which slipped from 1.36 to 1.22 basis points. Perp volume fell 5% quarter over quarter, and perp fees fell 16% as each dollar of perp volume paid less.

Derive spends its rebates on perp liquidity

Option makers took back 7.5% of option fees in Q3, against 55% of perp fees for perp makers. Derive added perpetuals because option traders needed a hedge.

Exhibit 5



Through Q3, each weekly buyback spent 35% of "applicable protocol fees" under DIP 313, with 65% to the insurance fund. DIP 324 raised the buyback share to half from Oct 14.

In Q3 the 14 weekly buybacks spent about $427K on DRV, an average of $30.5K a buyback: 30% of a week's fees before rebates and 37% after them. The DAO holds what it buys, and no fee reaches holders as cash.

Staking pays 1.9% a year in new DRV

DRV governs the Derive DAO, and holders who stake it get lower fee tiers and a share of the weekly staking emissions. DIP 313 cut staking emissions to 100,000 DRV a week from 250,000 on Apr 22, 2026, and cut the unstake wait to seven days. At that rate staking paid about 1.9% a year on the 273.5M DRV staked at Sep 30. Supply rose to 1.5B DRV after DIP 303 added 500M in 2025, for contributors and, held by the Foundation, for future hires and strategic deals.

Settlement moved to Ethereum; matching stays offchain

Derive began as Lyra, an options AMM on Optimism. It moved to an order book on its own chain in 2023 and took the Derive name in 2024, adding perpetuals and spot. On Oct 6, 2026, it retired that chain for Ethereum, which Derive chose for "neutrality and durability": a settlement layer institutions trust, without the custom bridges and wallets its own chain asked builders to support.

V3, which Derive launched that day, runs margin and settlement inside a zero-knowledge virtual machine, proves each batch on Ethereum and holds collateral in Ethereum contracts. Matching stays offchain at sub-millisecond speed. The new design puts new code in the custody path, and V3 keeps an escape hatch for it. If Derive leaves a withdrawal unprocessed past the protocol's timeout, another operator can continue settlement from the state Derive publishes to Celestia.

Financials

Option notional, ticket size, ETH open contracts and option fees all grew in Q3. Perps slipped on volume but held more open positions, and collateral grew by two thirds, mostly on prices.

Exhibit 6

Derive financial summary: activity, open positions, fees and net fees, Q3 2025, Q2 2026 and Q3 2026

	Q3 2025	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	vs Q2
Option notional	$1.18B	$3.94B	$7.45B	+89.4%
Perp volume	$598M	$2.10B	$1.98B	-5.4%
BTC and ETH option open interest, quarter end	n/a	$467M	$1.32B	+183.6%
Collateral, quarter end	$81.9M	$111M	$185M	+66.7%
Fees	$424K	$992K	$1.35M	+35.7%
Options	$280K	$535K	$906K	+69.4%
Perpetuals	$119K	$405K	$341K	-15.9%
Spot, liquidations, interest	$24.0K	$52.2K	$99.2K	+89.8%
Option fees per dollar of notional	2.37 bps	1.36 bps	1.22 bps	-10.6%
Maker rebates	$111K	$230K	$255K	+10.6%
Net fees after rebates	$313K	$762K	$1.09M	+43.2%
DRV set aside for maker programs	n/a	2.93M	2.63M	-10.1%

Quarter-end values. Spot plus liquidation plus interest fees.

Source: Derive; Derive Chain; DefiLlama · As of Sep 30, 2026

Alea

BTC and ETH option open interest averaged $836M in Q3, double Q2's $420M, and ended the quarter at $1.32B after September's build. BTC and ETH option notional turned over 7.6 times that average in Q3, against 6.9 times in Q2.

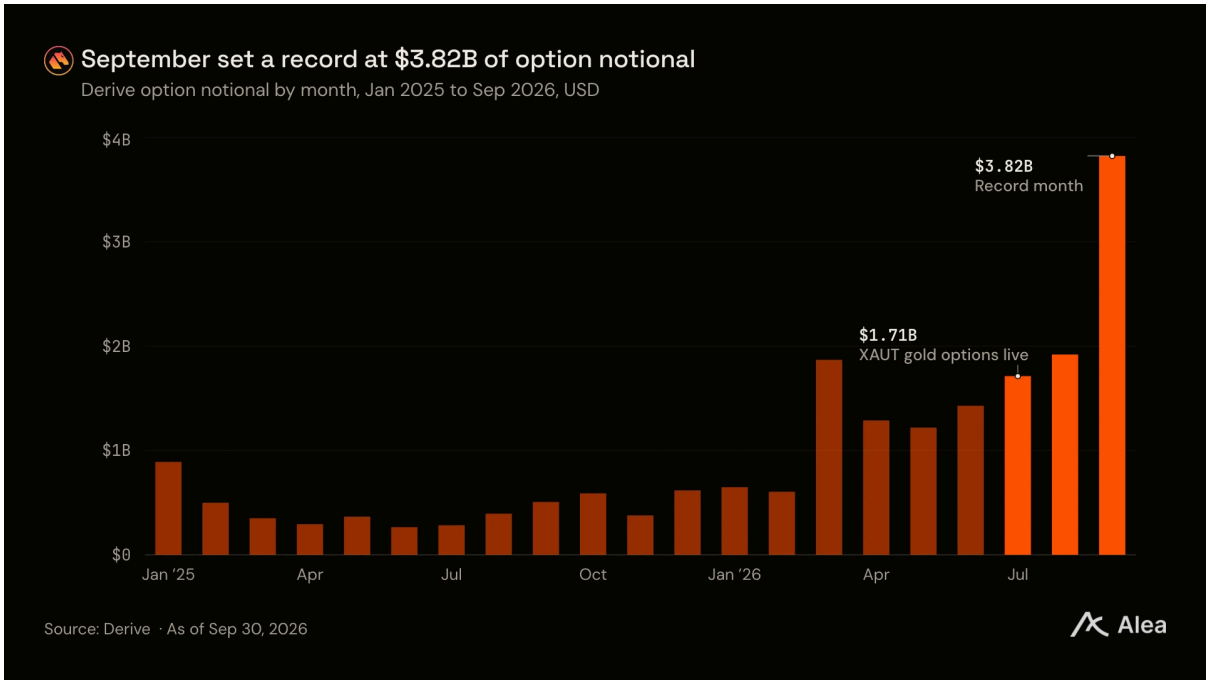
Options

Derive's options market grew on bigger tickets and on ETH. About 290 accounts traded on an average day across all products, up from 243 in Q2 and level with a year earlier.

RFQ trades averaged $165K against $35K on the order book, and the 622 RFQs of $1M or more, all legs counted, carried 54% of Q3 option notional; the ten largest RFQs carried 12%.

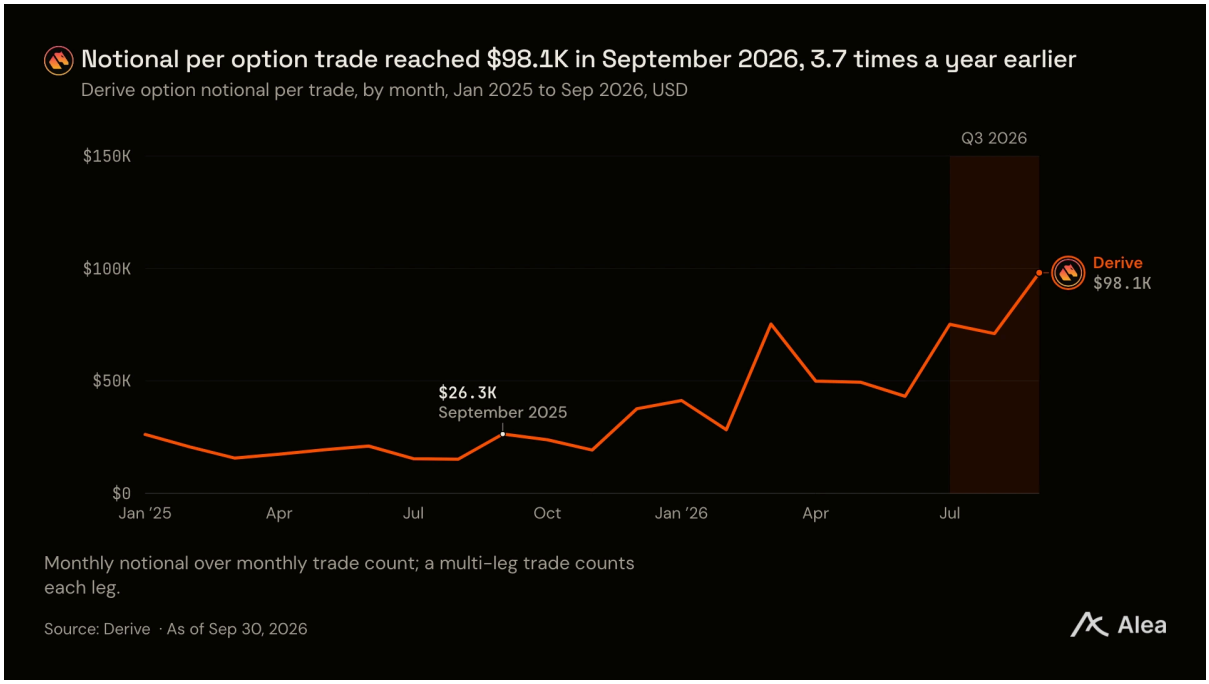
Option notional: Q3 beat all of 2025

Exhibit 7



Option notional reached $7.45B in Q3, above the $5.43B Derive traded in all of 2025. September alone carried nearly as much as all of Q2. Derive announced XAUT gold options on Jul 23, its first options on a real-world asset, and gold carried 1.0% of Q3 option notional at 1.48 basis points. Gold notional peaked at $40.3M in August, the month of Derive's gold-bar trading competition, and ran $24.6M in September.

Exhibit 8



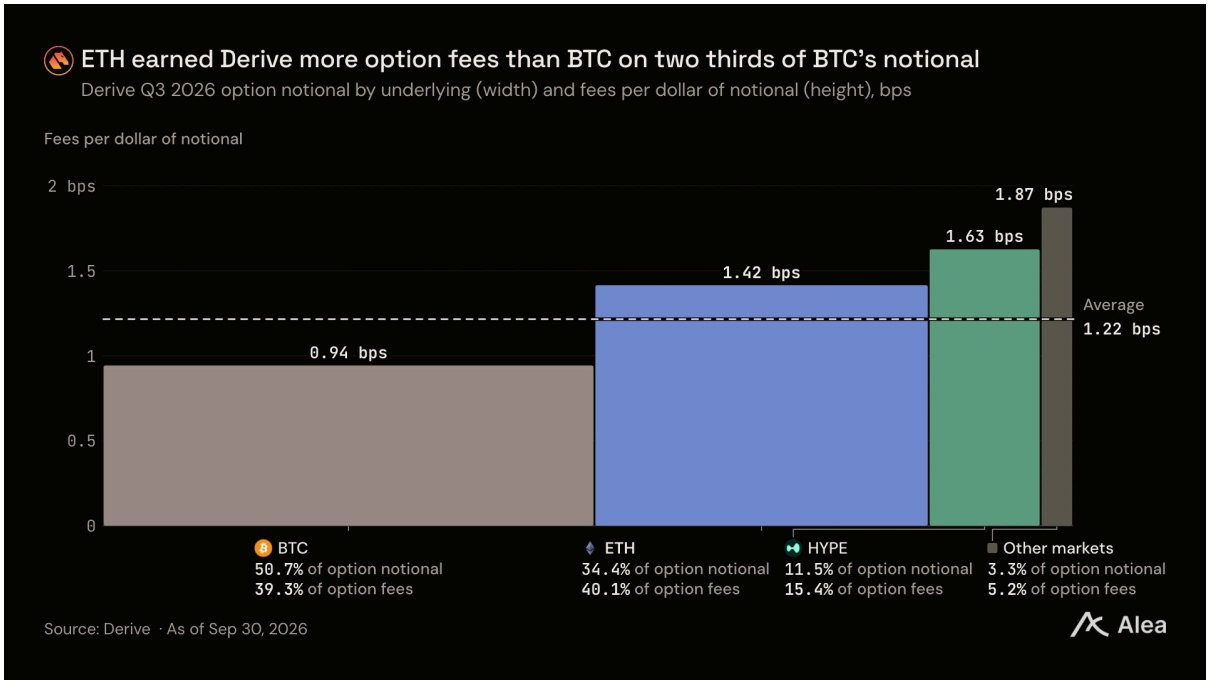
An option trade carried **$84K of notional on average in Q3**, against $47K in Q2 and $18.6K a year earlier. Without the two March 2027 call strikes, Q3 averaged $80K. Prices explain little of it: BTC averaged about the same in Q3 as in Q2, and ETH 6% more.

Markets: ETH out-earned BTC

ETH grew on block size: **its average trade tripled to $63K** from $20.5K in Q2, and ETH trades rose 11.3%. ETH notional climbed 3.4 times in Q3, to $2.57B, and ETH earned Derive more option fees than BTC did.

ETH options paid 1.42 basis points of fees per dollar of notional, against 0.94 for BTC. Both markets pay the same schedule, and most of the difference sits inside RFQ, where BTC trades paid 0.78 basis points in Q3 against 1.32 for ETH.

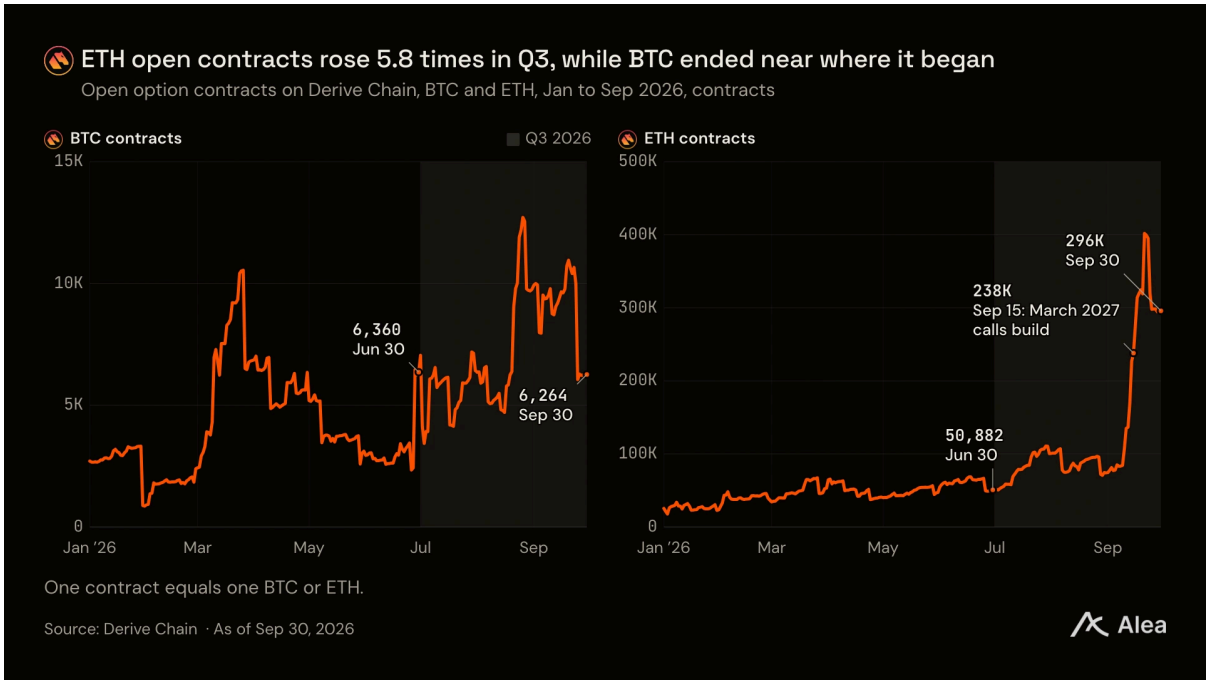
Exhibit 9



more than gold carried in the whole quarter. Higher rates on small markets make new listings worth more to fees than their size suggests: XRP and ZEC paid more than twice what BTC pays per dollar.

Open interest: ETH contracts rose 5.8 times, led by two March strikes

Exhibit 10



Dollar open interest rose with prices; contract counts show where positions grew. BTC contracts ended Q3 near the 6,300 where they began, after swinging higher in August, while their dollar value rose with BTC. Between Jun 30 and Sep 30, **ETH contracts rose from 50,882 to 295,972**, lifting ETH's open dollar value from $82M to $795M.

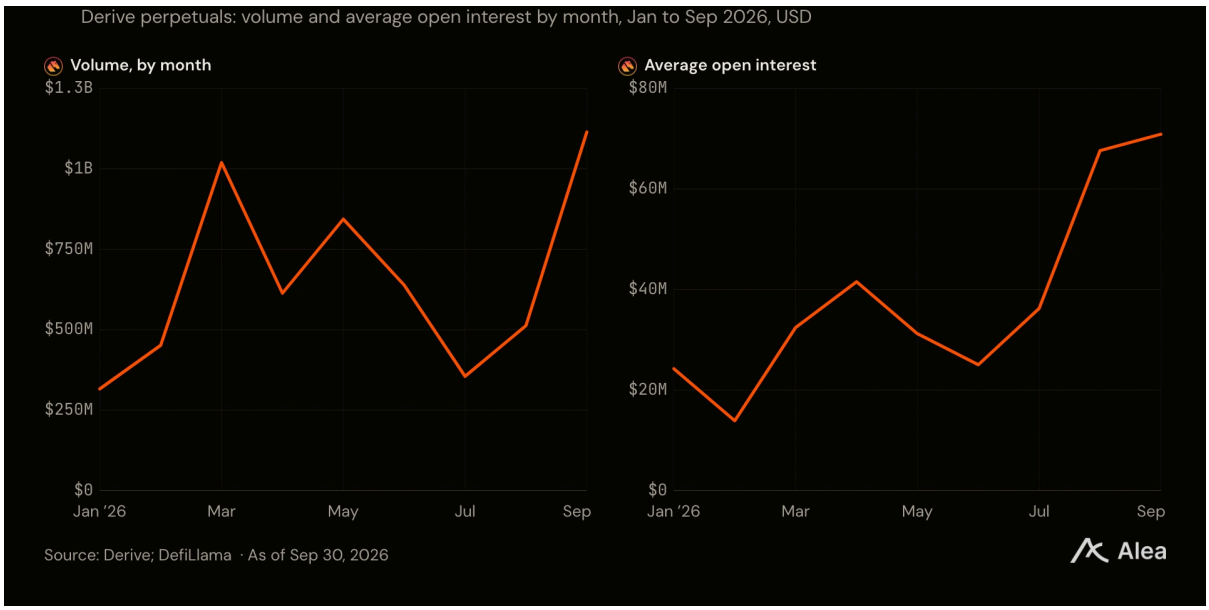
On Sep 15, about 85,500 contracts sat open on Derive at the $5,000 and $7,000 March 2027 strikes, mostly the legs of call spreads first bought on Sep 10. Trades in those two March strikes made up 16% of Q3 ETH option notional, at 1.27 basis points, close to the options average.

Perpetuals

Derive lists perpetuals for option traders to hedge in the same margin account. In Q3 perps earned a quarter of fees, and their positions stayed open longer.

Perp volume: positions stayed open about twice as long

Exhibit 11



Perp volume came to $1.98B in Q3, 5% below Q2, while open interest averaged $58.1M, up from $32.6M in Q2. Positions stayed open longer: Q3 volume ran at 34 times average open interest, against 64 times in Q2.

Volume still climbed every month, from $355M in July to $1.11B in September. Perp fees came to $341K, and fees per dollar ran at 1.72 basis points, down from 1.93 in Q2.

Collateral: up two thirds, mostly on prices

Collateral on Derive rose 66.7% in Q3, to $184.5M on Sep 30, and averaged $138.7M against $118.9M in Q2. wstETH was the largest holding, at $33.7M on Sep 30.

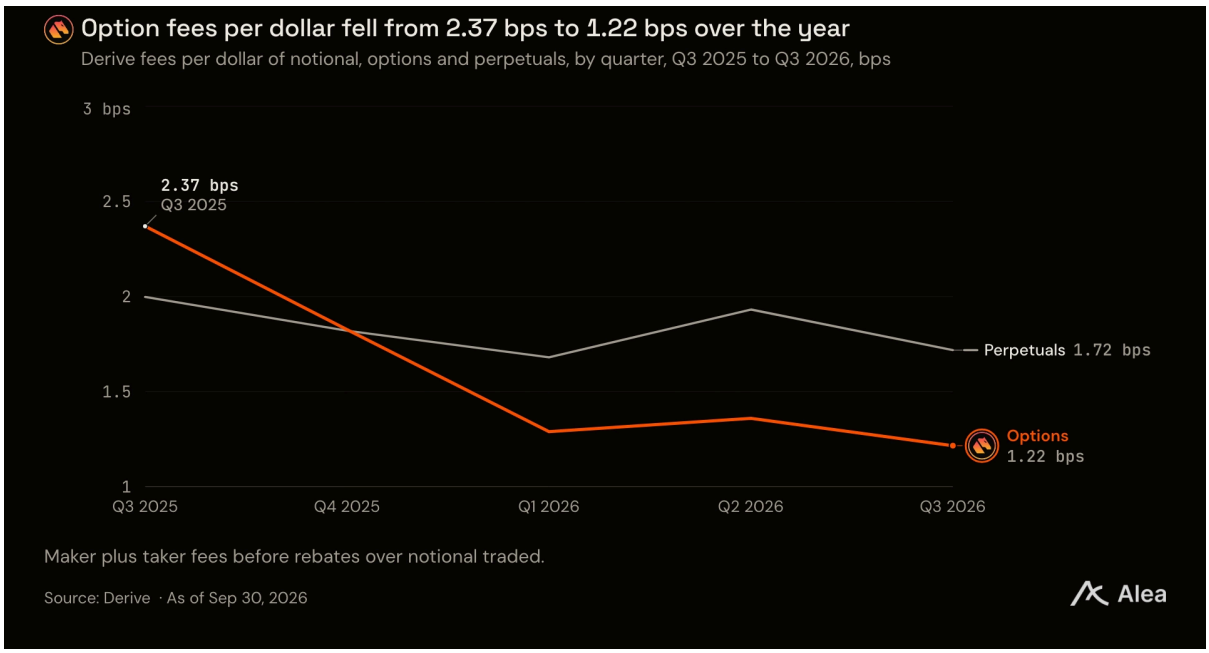
Exhibit 12



At Jun 30 token prices, collateral grew 24% in Q3; higher prices for wstETH, ETH, HYPE and BTC added the rest.

Income Statement

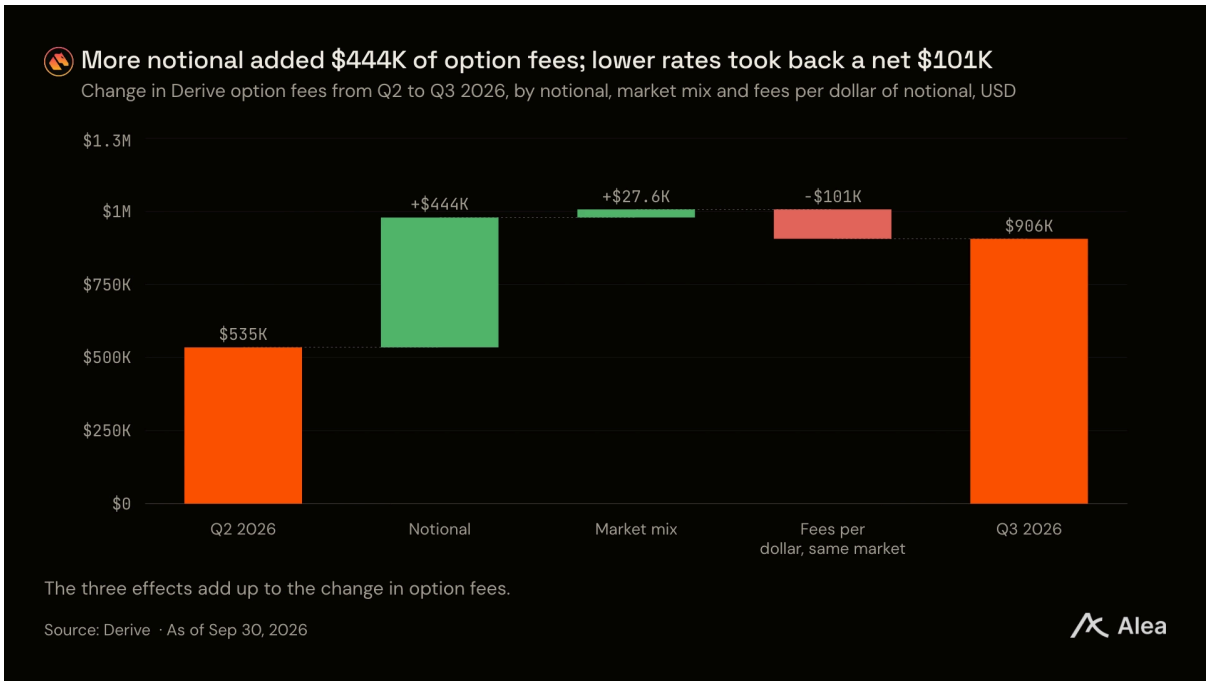
Net fees after rebates grew 43% in Q3, faster than fees, because rebates grew less. **The DAO kept 81% of Q3 fees**, up from 77% in Q2. In dollars at daily prices, Q3's $427K of buybacks compares with $219K of staking emissions and $439K of DRV set aside for maker programs.



Over the year, fees grew 3.2 times while option notional grew 6.3 times, because each dollar of option notional paid about half as much. The rate fell in steps, from 2.37 basis points in Q3 2025 to 1.29 in Q1 2026, while the average option trade grew from $18.6K to $50K.

The rate recovered to 1.36 in Q2, then set a new low in Q3. Option fees still rose $371K from Q2 to Q3.

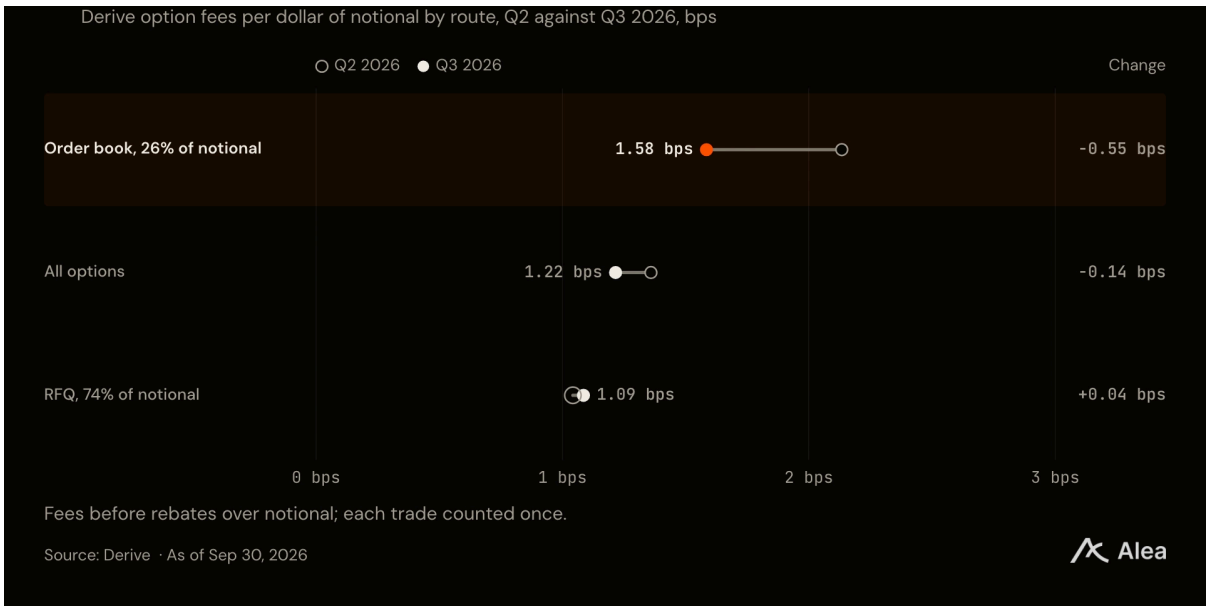
Exhibit 14



More notional added $444K of option fees. The market mix added a net $28K: ETH's larger share added $141K, and HYPE's smaller share took back $107K. Fees per dollar within markets took back a net $101K, as BTC's and ETH's rates fell and HYPE's rose.

Fees per dollar by route: discounts and the price cap cut the order book's rate

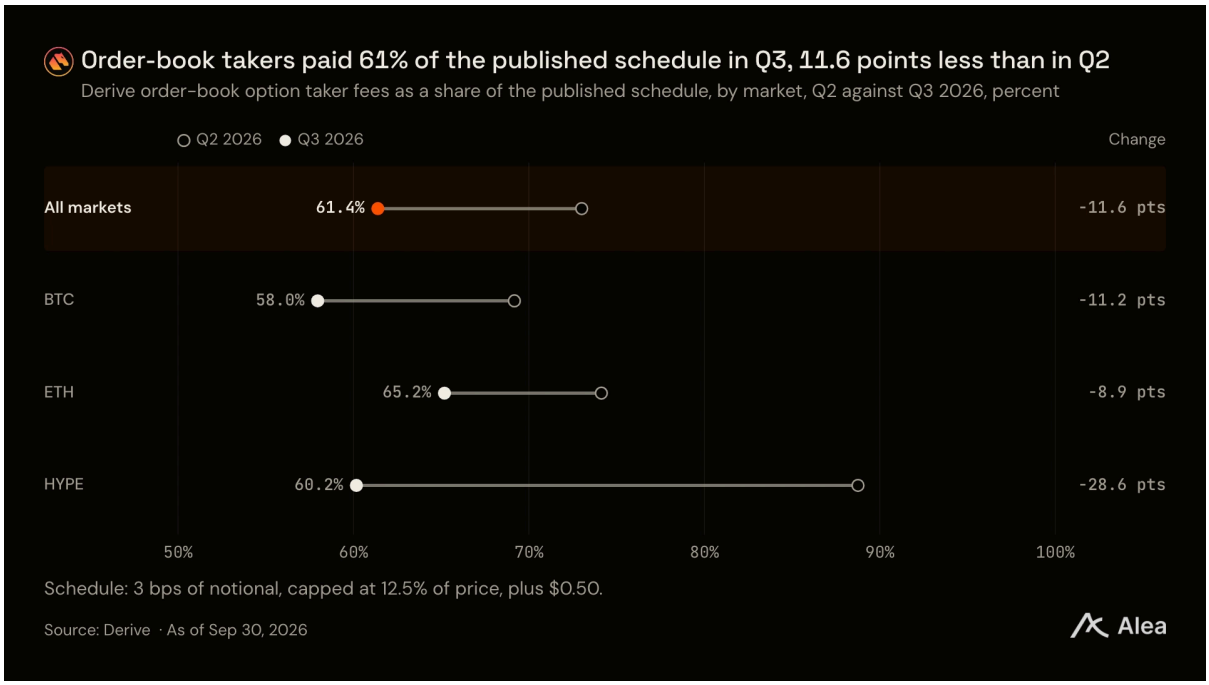
Exhibit 15



By route, **RFQ carried 74% of Q3 option notional**, up from 71% in Q2, at a steady rate near 1.1 basis points, while the order book's rate fell from 2.13 to 1.58 basis points.

The order book's lower rate took back $82K of option fees, RFQ's slightly higher rate added $17K, and RFQ's larger share took back $12K because RFQ is the cheaper route.

Exhibit 16

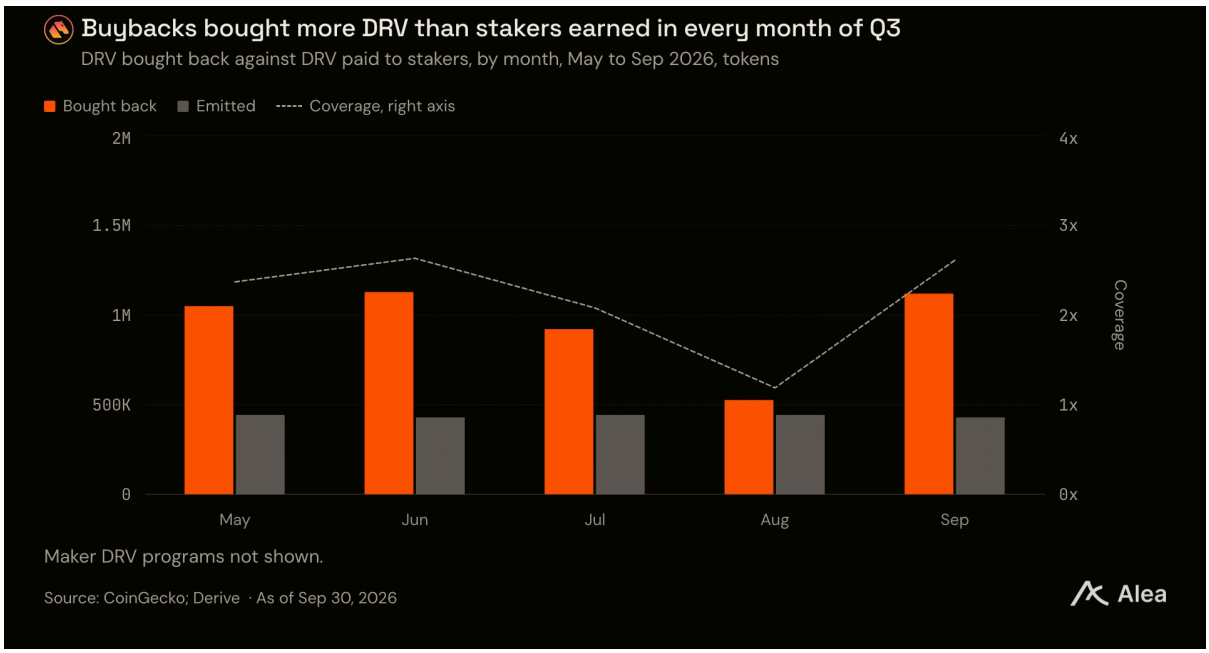


Deeper volume and staking discounts accounted for most of the order-book fall, 0.28 basis points. More notional at the price cap accounted for 0.18, as the capped share rose to 38% from 27% in Q2. The fixed $0.50 per order accounted for at most 0.09, as the average order-book trade grew.

Two rules apply to RFQ alone: top fee tiers discount RFQ fees by up to three quarters for takers and in full for makers, and the second leg of a two-leg spread is free. Each further gain in RFQ's share pulls the blended option rate toward RFQ's Q3 rate of 1.09 basis points, 11% below the quarter's 1.22.

Per-Token Economics

The weekly buyback turns fees into DRV demand, while staking pays out new DRV. In Q3, buybacks bought more DRV than stakers received.

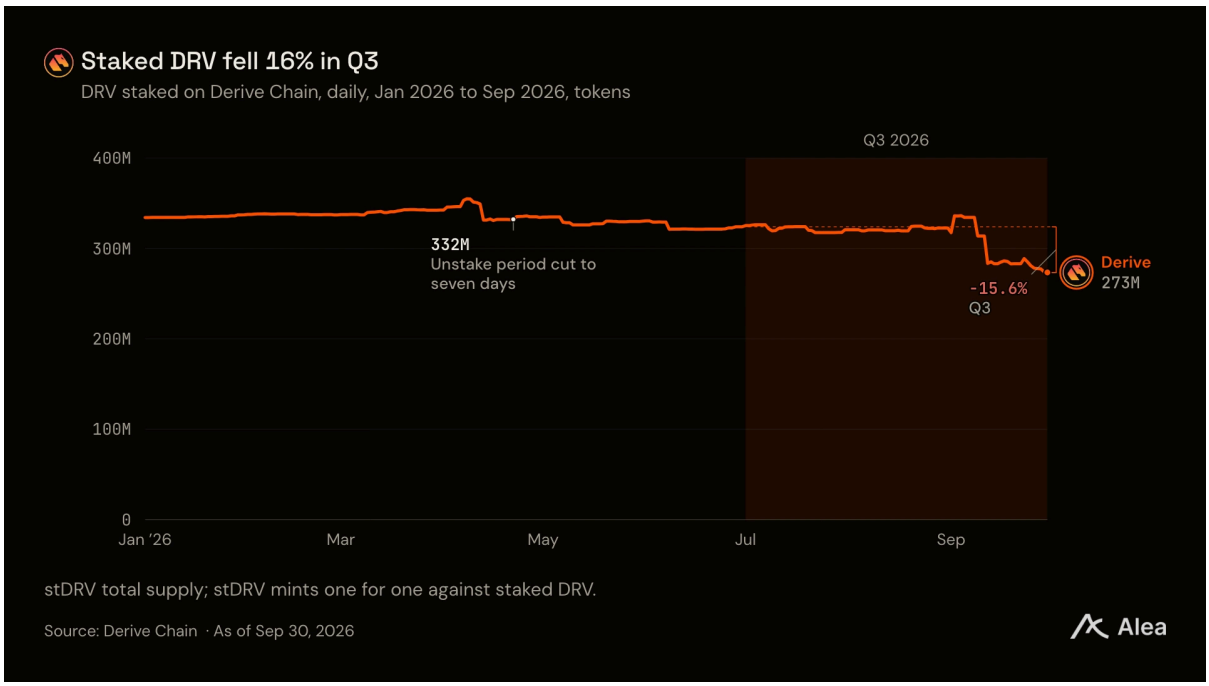


The DAO bought 2.57M DRV across the 14 weekly buybacks posted in Q3, an average of 183,000 DRV a buyback, **1.83 times the 100,000 DRV a week it paid to stakers**. At the Q3 pace, buybacks ran at 0.4% of DRV's Sep 30 market cap a year, while the buyback-to-staking ratio swung month to month with fees and the DRV price.

Maker programs add DRV on top: Derive configured 800,000 DRV per 28-day epoch in Q3 for the firms that quote its markets. Counted with those programs, weekly buybacks averaged 0.61 times the DRV set for stakers and makers.

Buybacks are set in dollars and staking emissions in tokens, which leaves the price to decide the balance. On October's net fees after rebates, the new buyback share spends $59K a week, 150,000 DRV at the Sep 30 close, against the 100,000 paid to stakers. It buys more DRV than stakers receive below about $0.59, and below about $0.20 it also covers the 200,000 DRV a week set for maker programs in Q3.

Exhibit 18



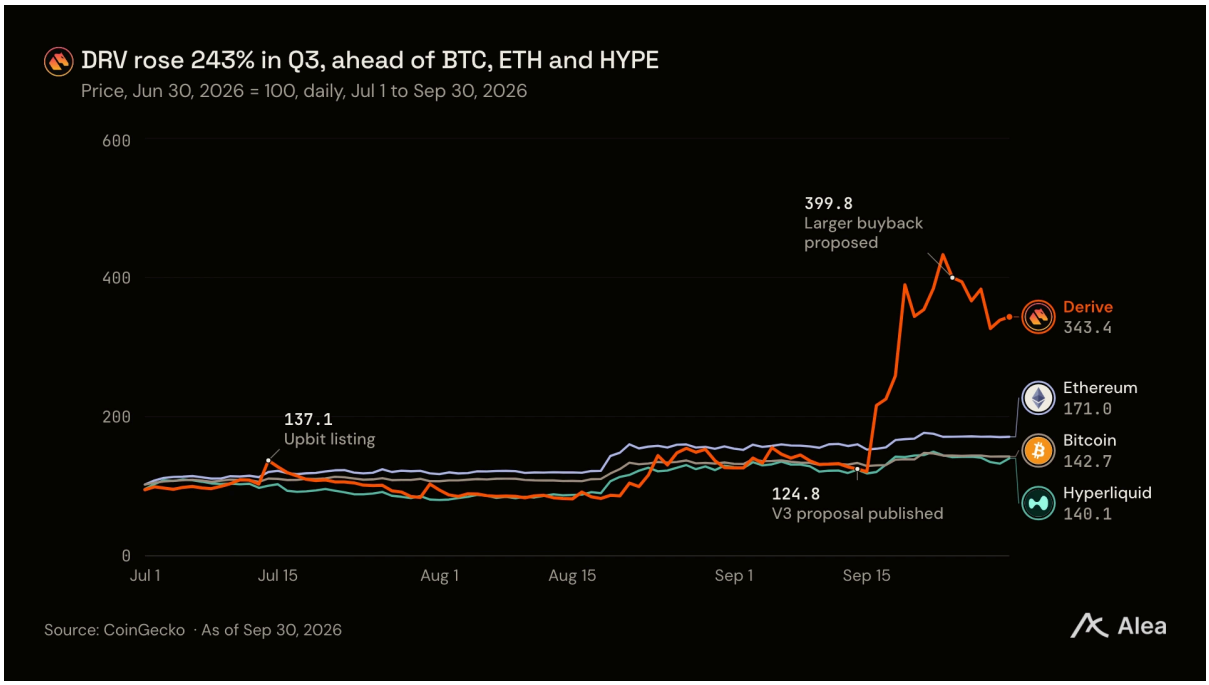
Staked DRV fell 16% in Q3, from 324.0M to 273.5M, most of it in two steps on Sep 9 and Sep 12, before the V3 proposal. Staked DRV's share of circulating supply fell to 27% from 32% in the quarter. V3 moved staking to Ethereum on Oct 6.

most about 70M DRV transferable on Sep 17, 7% of the 1.0B DRV in circulation.

Market Data

DRV rose 243% in Q3, from $0.113 to $0.389, closing the quarter at a $388M market cap and a $583M fully diluted value. Most of the move came in the week after the V3 proposal on Sep 14, three weeks before V3 went live on Oct 6.

Exhibit 19



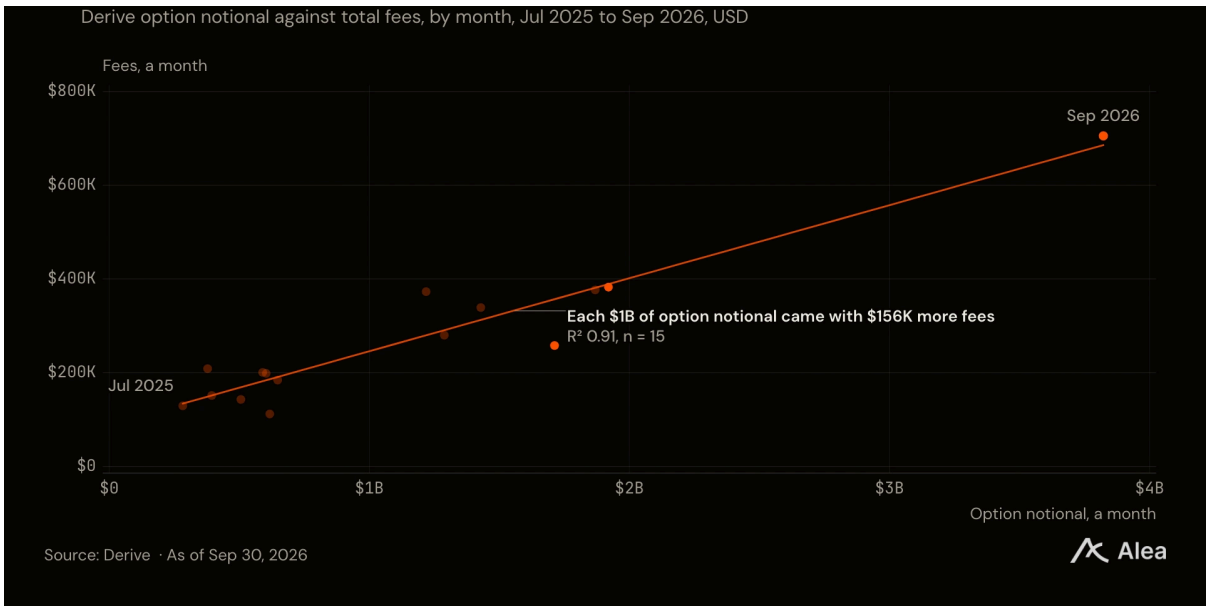
The gain ran well ahead of BTC, ETH and HYPE and of the 62% median of its five peers' tokens (HYPE, LIT, DYDX, GMX and DIME); only Paradex's DIME rose more, 318%. DRV listed on Hyperliquid spot, Upbit, Bithumb and Bitvavo in Q3. DRV more than tripled from $0.14 at the Sep 15 close to $0.44 at the Sep 19 close. The 50% buyback proposal followed on Sep 24.

DRV's trading volume rose to $1.19B in Q3 from $34M in Q2, and daily turnover to 7.8% of market cap from 0.4%. After the quarter, DRV closed at a record $0.54 on Oct 10, four days after V3 went live, and at $0.40 on Oct 19.

Outlook

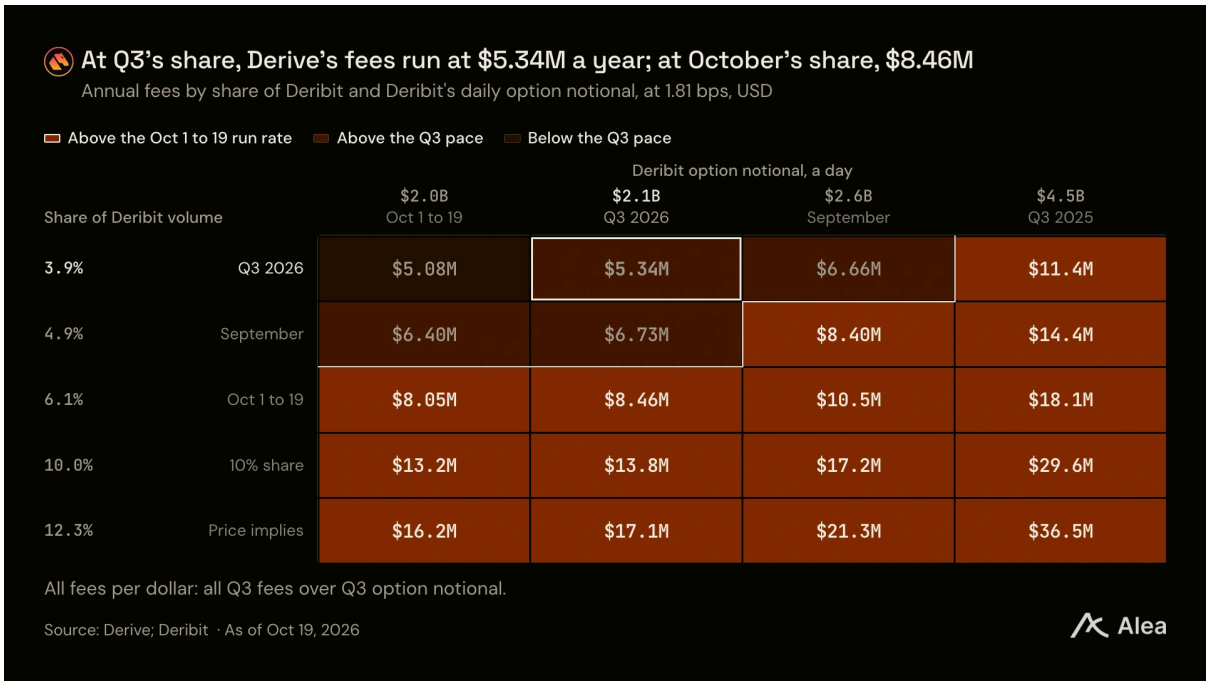
Derive's fees track its option notional closely. They equal its share of Deribit, times Deribit's volume, times what each dollar pays.

Exhibit 20



From July 2025 to September 2026, each extra $1B of monthly option notional came with about $156K more fees, or about $143K without September's record month. Without it, the fit's R^2 falls to 0.76 from 0.91. All fees, options and perps together, came to 1.81 basis points of option notional in Q3.

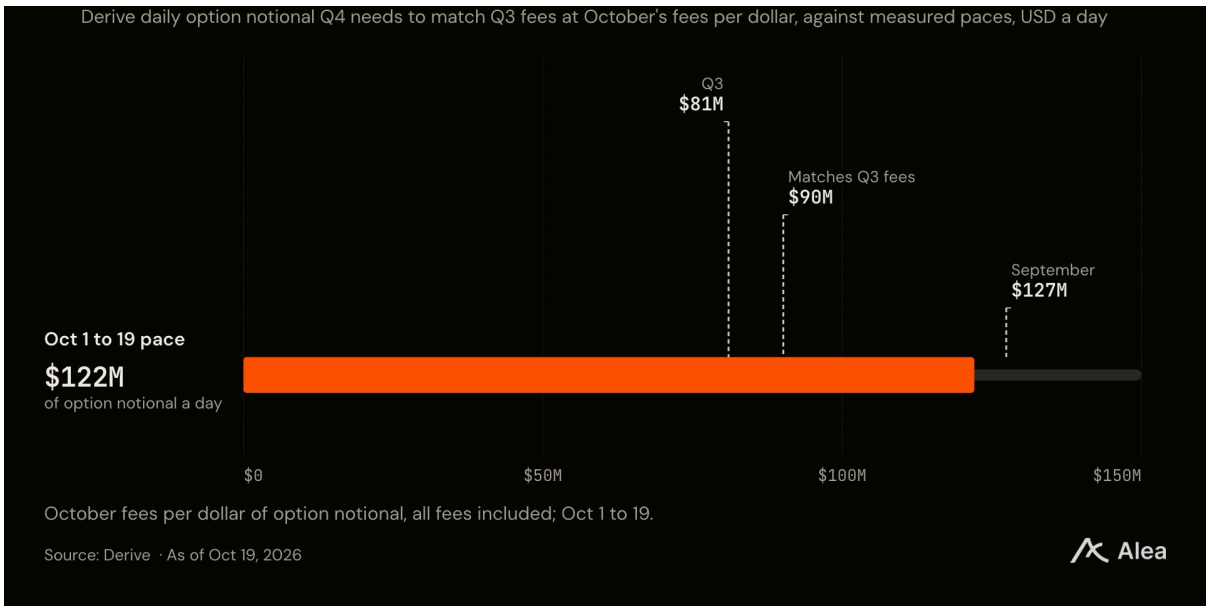
Exhibit 21



Hold Q3's 1.81 basis points and Deribit's Q3 pace, and fees run at $5.34M a year on Q3's share of Deribit. On October's 6.1% they run at $8.46M, or $6.9M on the 5.0% without Oct 3.

October's run rate was $7.2M, below the $8.05M its share of Deribit implies at Deribit's October pace and Q3's fee rate. One day explains the difference: on Oct 3, Derive matched $440M of option notional at 0.51 basis points of all fees, led by a four-leg BTC RFQ. Without that day, all fees per dollar of option notional ran at 1.88 basis points, above Q3's rate; at that rate Oct 3 alone would have added $1.2M a year.

Exhibit 22



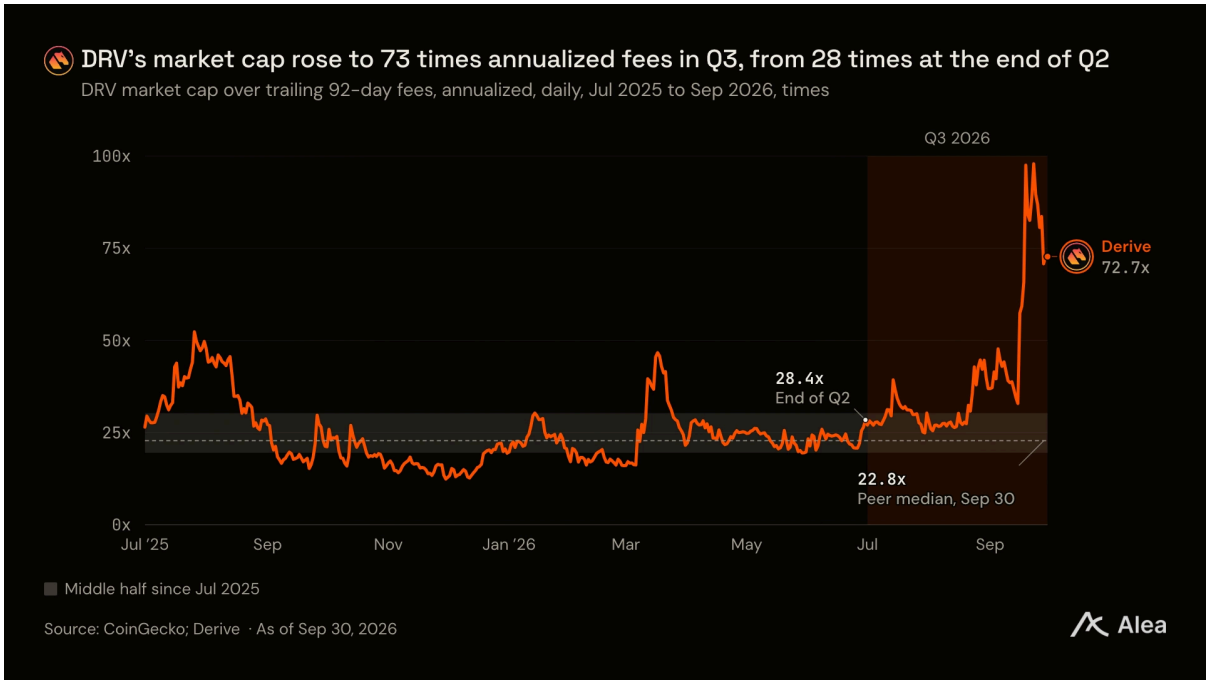
To match Q3 fees, Q4 needs $90M of option notional a day at October's rate of all fees per dollar, or $78M at its rate without Oct 3. Derive ran at $122M a day from Oct 1 to Oct 19, **35% above that line**, and at $105M on the median day; the migration days, Oct 4 to 6, ran below it.

Valuation

DRV's price assumes Derive keeps gaining share on Deribit, as it has in each of the last four quarters. DRV's multiple falls as fees catch up with the price, and the pace of that share gain sets how fast they do.

Multiples: 73 times fees against a 23 times peer median

Exhibit 23



DRV's market cap ended Sep 30 at 73 times annualized fees. That was up from 28 times at the end of Q2 and above 97% of the days since July 2025. On fully diluted value DRV traded at 109 times, much closer to the 80 times peer median, because about two thirds of its supply circulates against about a quarter of HYPE's and LIT's. At the Oct 19 close and October's fee pace, the multiple was 55 times.

Exhibit 24

Derive and five traded derivatives venues, Q3 2026: market cap, fees, market cap to annualized fees and to annualized revenue

Protocol	Market cap Sep 30	Q3 fees Q3 total	vs Q2 Q3 over Q2	Market cap to fees annualized Q3	Market cap to revenue annualized Q3
Derive	$388M	$1.35M	+35.7%	72.7x	89.7x
Lighter	$988M	$12.5M	+30.3%	20.0x	25.3x
Hyperliquid	$20.2B	$224M	+11.1%	22.8x	29.3x
GMX	$82.8M	$14.5M	+3.9%	1.4x	4.3x
Paradex	$7.38M	$58.4K	-70.7%	31.9x	n/a
dYdX	$122M	$827K	n/a	37.1x	37.1x

Paradex publishes no revenue; dYdX's Q2 fee history has a gap.

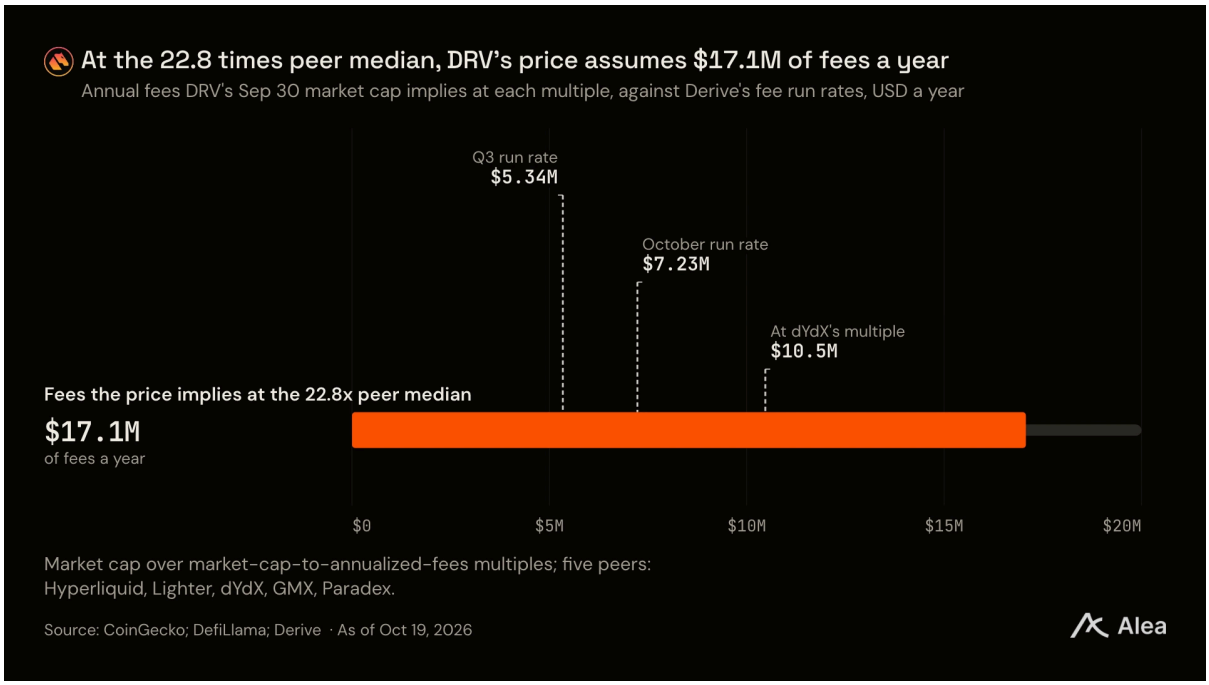
Source: CoinGecko; Derive; DefiLlama · As of Sep 30, 2026

Alea

The peers are five traded derivatives venues with public fee data for a full Q2 and liquid tokens: Hyperliquid and Lighter, the largest by market cap, and dYdX, GMX and Paradex. Their medians are 23 times annualized fees and 27 times annualized revenue, against 90 times revenue for DRV. GMX trades at 1.4 times fees but 4.3 times revenue because most of its fees pay its liquidity providers, and Paradex earned $58K of Q3 fees because it charges retail traders nothing.

Derive's fees grew 36% in Q3, **against a 7.5% median for the four peers** with a full Q2 fee history. Derive grew faster than every peer it can be measured against.

Exhibit 25

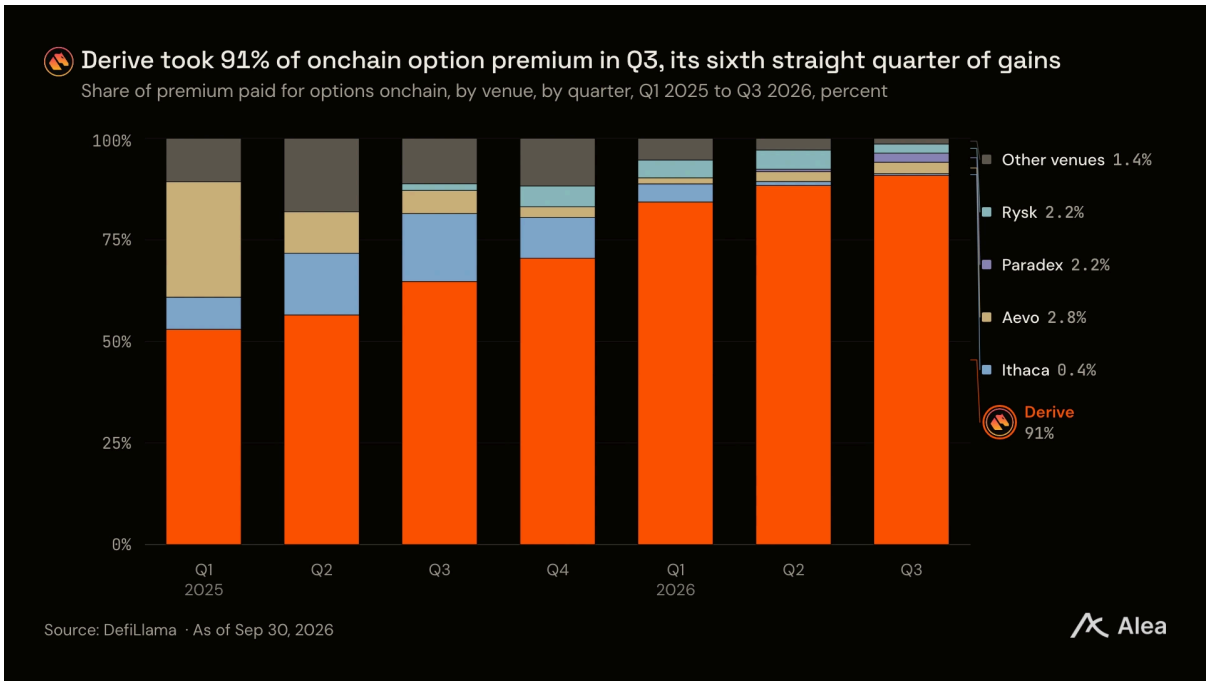


At Hyperliquid's 22.8 times fees, the middle of the five peers, DRV's Sep 30 price assumes $17.1M of fees a year, against October's pace of $7.2M. At Q3's 1.81 basis points and Deribit's Q3 volume, that level needs about a 12% share of Deribit, against Q3's 3.9%.

BTC is the lever: it carried 87% of Deribit's Q3 option notional, and Derive's share of it was 2.25%. At the last four quarters' average gain of about 0.9 points a quarter, the share the price implies is about nine quarters away, or four to five at Q3's gain of 1.8 points. On fully diluted value, the 80 times peer median implies $7.3M of fees a year, about October's pace.

Derive leads the onchain field by a wide margin, and against Deribit it gains most in ETH. Its onchain rivals added products and rewards in the quarter, while Deribit entered the HYPE market Derive leads.

Exhibit 26

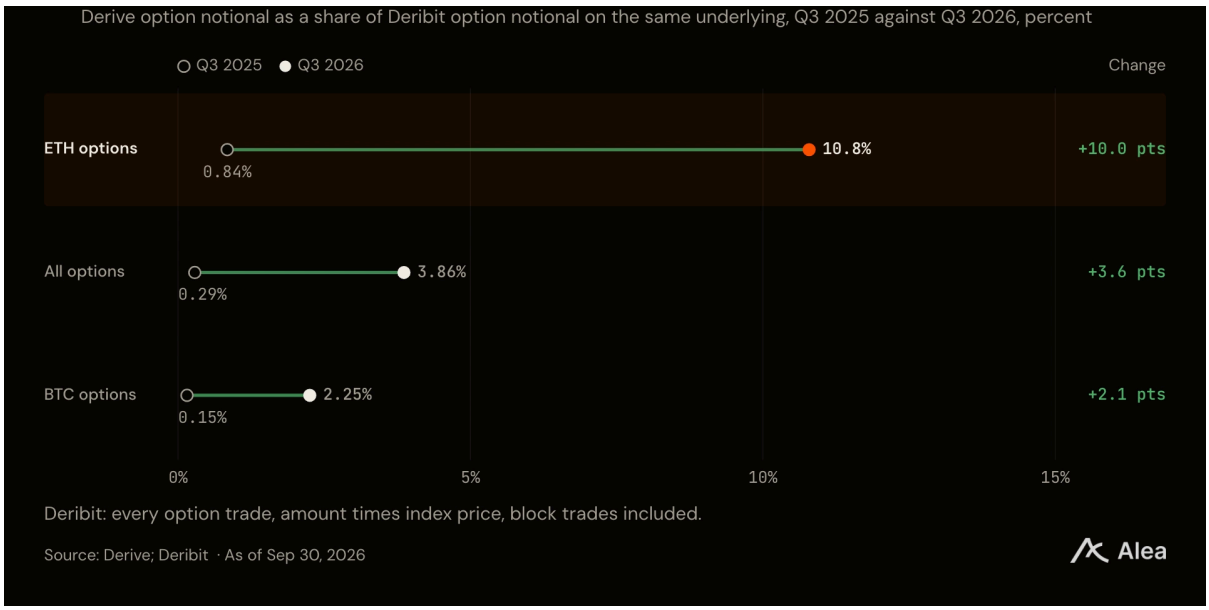


Premium paid for options onchain came to $193M in Q3, and Derive took 90.9% of it, up from 64.8% a year earlier, its sixth straight quarter of gains in onchain share. Most of the gain came from Ithaca, whose share nearly vanished, and from smaller venues; Aevo had 2.8%, down from 5.7%, and Paradex and Rysk 2.2% each.

In Q3 Aevo added an easier options mode on Aug 20 and SOL options on Sep 2, and it pays options traders 300,000 AEVO a week. On Sep 16 Paradex, which advertises zero trading fees, opened Paradigm's RFQ network onchain; it listed ZEC options on Sep 25 and, from Sep 28 to Oct 3, options on US500, US100, gold and crude oil. Its XP rewards weighted options trading every week until the program ended on Oct 13.

Measured by notional, Paradex's share of onchain options rose from 4.2% in Q3 to 10.4% from Oct 1 to 19, or 7.0% without Oct 3, a day that carried nearly half of Paradex's notional for the window. Derive's share went from 85.0% to 82.1%, or 83.8% without that day. Derive added price protection to RFQs on Oct 14: a trader takes any better quote that arrives during review. From Oct 4, Tacticalls, a Derive front end, priced Paradex beside Derive. Hypercall's equity options on Hyperliquid, live since June, sit outside these shares.

Exhibit 27



Derive traded 10.8% of Deribit's ETH option notional in Q3. Excluding trades in the two March 2027 call strikes, Derive's ETH notional still equaled 9.1% of Deribit's. From Oct 1 to 19 the gain spread to BTC, where Derive's share rose to 4.4% of Deribit's option notional from 2.25% in Q3. Without Oct 3, when Derive's $405M of BTC options exceeded Deribit's that day, the share was 3.2%.

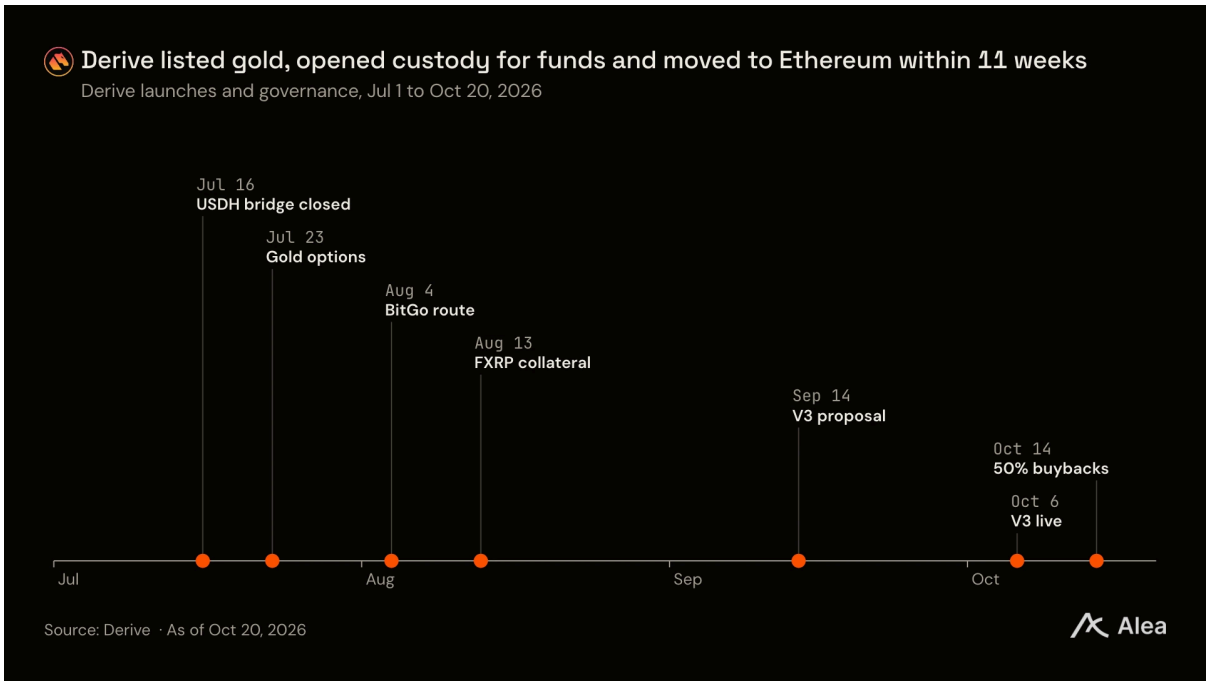
Deribit listed HYPE options in late June, and Bybit listed them on Aug 4. Deribit's HYPE option notional rose to $271M in Q3 from $12.5M in Q2, while Derive's fell to $860M from $974M. Derive still traded 3.2 times Deribit's HYPE volume.

Deribit's option notional fell 53%, from $412.7B in Q3 2025 to $192.9B in Q3 2026. In July Deribit paid block traders holding at least 200,000 USDC fee rebates of up to half their fees during a trading competition. Most of Deribit's fall was price: BTC averaged 38% less in Q3 than a year earlier, and ETH 45% less. Coinbase International Exchange consolidated into Deribit on Oct 1, which made Deribit, already Coinbase-owned, its international derivatives venue.

Significant Updates

In Q3 Derive listed gold options and opened a custody route for funds. Both widen who can trade on Derive: gold brings a non-crypto underlying, and the BitGo route brings funds that keep their assets in custody.

Exhibit 28



V3 migrated without a redeposit

DIP 322 drew 107.1M staked DRV for V3 and 0.65M against. The vote closed on Oct 4 at 99.4% for. The migration ran on Oct 6 without a redeposit, and Derive allowed up to a week for withdrawals of some assets to resume. V3 lets eligible traders net ETH and BTC risk in one account and borrow ETH, WBTC and HYPE as well as USDC, and it builds vaults and account permissions into the protocol itself.

Builders shipped front ends on V3 within two weeks. Tacticalls moved to V3 on day one, Tunder followed on Oct 7, Heat went live on Oct 13, and Toros announced a route that brings Derive liquidity to Base. Each front end routes orders into Derive's liquidity, through RFQ or the order book, the builder model Hyperliquid also uses.

Holders closed the bridge for USDH, Hyperliquid's former native stablecoin, in July, at the request of USDH's team. DIP 318 passed on Jul 16 with 22.75M DRV for and none against; it closed the bridge and returned USDH to its owners.

Derive added a custody route, gold options and XRP collateral

The BitGo route opened on Aug 4. Strands verifies BitGo balances and mints a one-to-one token that serves as collateral. A fund can trade options on Derive while BitGo keeps holding its assets.

Flare's FXRP became collateral for Derive's XRP options on Aug 13. LIT, PUMP and VVV options traded $1.2M of notional between them in the quarter. After the quarter, kHYPE arrived on Ethereum as collateral on Oct 13, and direct USDC funding from HyperEVM opened on Oct 16.

Buybacks took half of applicable fees from Oct 14

DIP 324 passed on Oct 5 with 47.7M votes for and none against. Buyback #88 confirmed the new share, cutting the insurance fund's share from 65% to 50%. DRV also listed on Binance Alpha on Oct 14.

Roadmap

Derive has announced three directions without dates. Each widens what feeds fees or DRV: more markets on V3, buyback-funded staking, and a regulated US venue.

Vaults and new markets arrive on V3 "over the coming weeks". Derive announced new markets, vaults and partner integrations on that timeline and gave real-world assets no date. Newer markets already trade: LIT and PUMP options carried $7.9M and $2.4M of notional from Oct 1 to 19.

DIP 324 lays the base for buyback-funded staking rewards. It names the larger buyback share as the source for paying stakers from buybacks instead of new emissions; no proposal has set the switch. At October's pace, a year of buybacks would come to about 2.9% of staked DRV at the Sep 30 price, about 1.5 times the emissions rate.

Derive is exploring a regulated US venue. On Aug 28 Derive published its comment letter on the CFTC and SEC request about the definition of a swap. On Sep 16, Alex van Voorhees, a Chief Legal and Compliance Officer with 20 years in derivatives law joined Derive. DIP 329, which Derive posted on the forum on Oct 12, asks holders to let the Foundation pursue US registrations with treasury funds. It names no product or date. By Oct 2, Coinbase had opened onboarding for its US Prime clients to trade crypto options through Coinbase Financial Markets, with trading expected in Q4.

Derive's treasury wallets held about $10.8M of assets other than DRV on Sep 30.

Catalysts Ahead

DIP 329 vote: not yet scheduled. A yes would let the Foundation spend treasury funds on US registrations; the treasury held $10.8M of assets other than DRV on Sep 30.

After Oct 13: Paradex without its XP program. Paradex's XP rewards, which weighted options trading, ended on Oct 13, and its onchain notional share was 7.0% from Oct 1 to 19 without Oct 3.

20 to 26, 2.4 times Q3's average week. By Oct 21, about 157,300 contracts sat open on Derive at the two ETH March call strikes, mostly the legs of call spreads. That is up from about 85,500 on Sep 15, and the two strikes held 72% of ETH open interest on Derive for the March expiry.

Conclusion

Derive enters Q4 on Ethereum with 6.1% of Deribit's option notional from Oct 1 to 19, 5.0% without the Oct 3 block day, and its gain has spread from ETH to BTC. About 290 accounts traded on an average Q3 day, up from 243 in Q2, and half of applicable protocol fees now buy DRV.

Appendix

The definitions below fix what each number measures, and the restatements explain why provider dashboards show different fee totals for 2026.

Definitions

Option notional. Contracts traded times the index price of the underlying, summed per UTC day. A trade counts once, covering both its buyer and its seller. It measures exposure; premium measures money paid.

Option trades. Each leg of a multi-leg order counts as one trade, as on Derive's statistics page. Notional per trade is notional per leg.

Notional counting basis. Derive and Deribit both count each trade once. In Q1 2024, when makers paid a flat 1 basis point on perps, Derive's maker fees came to exactly 1.00 basis point of perp notional.

Option premium. The price paid for options, summed per UTC day. Premium and notional never add.

Fees. Maker and taker fees on options, perpetuals and spot, plus liquidation and interest fees, before rebates, as the Derive stats page totals them.

Net fees. Fees less rebates, all of which went to makers in 2026.

Fees per dollar. Fees over notional on the same days, in basis points (hundredths of a percent).

Fee bridge. Splits the change in option fees between two quarters into notional, market mix and fees per dollar within each market. Log-mean weights make the three parts add up to the change.

Share of Deribit. Derive option notional over Deribit option notional on the same UTC days. Deribit's figure counts every BTC, ETH and USDC-settled option trade, block trades included. Derive's figure counts every Derive option market, HYPE, ZEC and XAUT included; on BTC and ETH alone the Q3 ratio was 3.3%.

DRV buybacks. DRV bought in each weekly buyback times the average price.

Buyback coverage. DRV bought per weekly buyback over the 100,000 DRV paid to stakers each week at the DIP 313 rate; the monthly figure compares the DRV bought and paid in each calendar month.

Option open interest. The dollar value of open BTC and ETH option contracts on Derive's statistics page, averaged over the quarter's days. It leaves out HYPE and the smaller markets.

RFQ share. Option notional from trades that carry a request-for-quote id in Derive's trade history, over all option notional.

Market cap to fees. Market cap at the day's close over the last 92 days of fees, annualized.

Market cap to revenue. Market cap over annualized Q3 revenue: for Derive, net fees after rebates; for peers, fees less what they pay liquidity providers, as DefiLlama reports them.

Restatements

Every fee figure here uses the stats page.

The buyback running total. Buyback post #80 dropped the #78 and #79 purchases, 296,872 DRV, from its running total, and post #67 added 79,203 DRV more than its weekly amount (since the previous week underreported). The 14 weekly amounts in Q3 sum to 2,566,586 DRV, and that sum is the one used here.

Paradex's market cap. CoinGecko counted 668M DIME in circulation from Aug 13 to Oct 15, 2026, and 186.1M from Oct 16, its own correction. The report values DIME on 186.1M for those days; on CoinGecko's Sep 30 count, Paradex would trade at 114 times annualized Q3 fees, against 32 on the corrected one.

Data Availability

Premium by venue. The onchain premium share covers the venues DefiLlama tracks, and Hypercall isn't among them.

Maker rewards paid. Derive published the DRV configured for each maker program and the USDC pool size; the DRV paid per epoch is unpublished. The maker-programs API configured 800,000 DRV per 28-day epoch through Q3; the docs page now reads 1M DRV per epoch, and DIP 324 lists 50,000 DRV a week of protocol incentives, which leaves the 0.61 times weekly coverage and the $0.20 crossover tied to the API figure.

Option premium after Oct 6. DefiLlama tracks V3 premium under a new listing from Oct 7, which splits Derive's premium history at the migration.

Buyback fee base. DIP 324 doesn't publish the weekly "applicable protocol fees" each buyback uses or say whether market-maker rebates come out before the split, which leaves weekly buybacks between 30% and 37% of weekly fees on the quarter's average.

Share of all crypto options. The share is measured against Deribit; option notional on Bybit, OKX and Binance isn't in it.

Open interest history. Deribit's public API returns open interest for the present moment only, which rules out a period open-interest share against Deribit.

Staked DRV withdrawals. Derive Chain shows the Sep 9 and Sep 12 steps (20.6M and 30.3M DRV) but not who unstaked or why.

USDC lending. Derive's statistics report interest fees on USDC loans, $42.7K in Q3 against $6.7K in Q2, but not the Q3 borrow balance or rate behind them.

Peer growth against valuation. dYdX's fee history on DefiLlama misses Jun 26 to 30, which leaves fee growth for four of the five peers; the peer table sets growth beside each venue's multiples in place of a growth-against-multiple chart.

Ithaca's share. Ithaca's share of onchain option premium fell to 0.4% from 16.7% over the year, and Ithaca has published no figures that explain the fall.

Open interest beyond BTC and ETH. The option open interest series covers BTC and ETH; HYPE and the smaller markets sit outside it. Derive's own post put open interest above $4.58B on Oct 4 without stating its basis, against $1.32B for BTC and ETH options at Sep 30.

Open interest by expiry. Derive's V2 statistics didn't break open interest down by expiry, which leaves the Sep 25 expiry without a comparison for Dec 25.

Peer fee history. dYdX's fee series misses Jun 26 to 30, which leaves its change from Q2 blank. Aevo has no fee history in DefiLlama's fee dataset, which keeps it out of the multiples.

Builder and BitGo flow. Derive doesn't publish the notional routed through builder front ends or the collateral minted for the BitGo route, which leaves both launches without a size.

Perp hedging. Trade history doesn't mark a perp trade as a hedge of an option position, which leaves the longer perp holding time without a measured cause.

V2 rewards pending. Derive hasn't published the total of V2 trading and staking rewards still unclaimed.

Treasury transfers. DefiLlama's tracker shows Derive's treasury wallets holding 452.8M DRV on Sep 30, down from 512.8M on Jun 30, after 22.8M left on Sep 24 and 23.2M on Sep 29; the balance was back to 487.7M by Oct 19. On Sep 21 and Sep 28, $8.5M of USDC arrived from one address. Derive hasn't said what the transfers paid for.

Data Sources

Every figure above comes from one canonical source per metric, chosen after comparing the providers that carry it.

Option notional. Derive, from the daily notional its statistics page publishes by market and instrument; DefiLlama, which reads the same API, matched it within 0.04% for Q3 2026.

Perp volume. Derive, from the perpetual notional on its statistics page; DefiLlama's derivatives series ran 0.4% higher for Q3 2026 because its days close at a different hour.

Option premium. DefiLlama, from its options dashboard, the only premium history, since Derive's statistics page carries notional and fees but not premium.

Option fees. Derive, summing option maker and taker fees per day on its statistics page.

Perp fees. Derive, summing perpetual maker and taker fees from its statistics page.

Interest fees. Derive, from the interest spread on USDC lending that its statistics page records.

Fees. Derive, adding trading, liquidation and interest fees as its statistics page totals them; DefiLlama read 25.4% higher for Q3 2026 because it double counted Derive fees before its Aug 24 adapter fix.

Maker rebates. Derive, from the rebates booked against each instrument on its statistics page.

Net fees. Derived as fees less maker rebates, both from Derive.

DRV buybacks. Derive, multiplying the DRV in each weekly buyback post by the average price stated beside it.

DRV bought. Derive, summing the weekly amounts in the same posts; the posted running total's Q3 change reads 11.6% lower because post #80 dropped two Q3 purchases.

Staking emissions. Derive, applying the weekly rate in DIP 313 to each day.

Staked DRV. Derive Chain, reading the stDRV supply at each day's last block.

Collateral. DefiLlama, from the daily balance on its Derive page, counted on the chain each asset was bridged from.

Option trades. Derive, counting the option trades its statistics page lists.

Notional per option trade. Derived as option notional over option trades, both from Derive.

DRV price. CoinGecko, using the daily close aggregated across DRV's trading venues.

DRV trading volume. CoinGecko, from DRV's daily trading volume aggregated across its trading venues.

Share of Deribit option volume. Derived as Derive option notional from its statistics page over Deribit option notional from its public trade history, on the same UTC days.

Option notional by route. Derive, from every option trade in its V3 trade history, counted once per trade and pulled one UTC day at a time; it matches the statistics page's daily notional to the dollar for Q2 and Q3 2026, and its fees within 0.1%.

Perp open interest. DefiLlama, from the daily open interest on its Derive page, averaged per day for period statistics and by month in the perps figure.

Option open interest, Oct 21. Derive, from current option open interest per currency in its V3 API. It counts contracts of one BTC or one ETH.

Daily active accounts. Derive, from the trading accounts its statistics page counts per UTC day.

Deribit option notional. Deribit, adding up every option trade in its public trade history at amount times index price, from its public trade history.

References

Protocol rules: trading fees, market maker programs, DIP 318, DIP 303, DIP 313, DIP 324, DIP 322, DIP 329.

Quarter events: XAUT options, BitGo custody, XRP options with FXRP, V3 is live, the thinking behind V3, V3 vote.

Data: Derive statistics, Deribit volume statistics, DefiLlama options, DRV on CoinGecko.

Peers: Coinbase International Exchange consolidates into Deribit, Aevo Options Easy Mode, Hypercall documentation.

Disclosures

This report on Derive was not paid for or commissioned. Alea maintains Derive's Data Room.

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